Justice and Empowerment, Plan Division, 2018), pp. 29, 238, http://socialjustice.nic.in/writereaddata/UploadFile/HANDBOOKSocialWelfareStatistice2018.pdf. For the SC caste breakdown of UP, see, for instance, Census of India 2001, *Uttar Pradesh—Data Highlights: The Scheduled Castes*, https://censusindia.gov.in/tables_published/scst/dh_sc_up.pdf.

11. And STs are 0.57 per cent of the population in UP. Calculated by the author from UP caste data in Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, *Handbook on Social Welfare Statistics 2018* (New Delhi: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment, Plan Division, 2018), http://socialjustice.nic.in/writereaddata/UploadFile/HANDBOOKSocialWelfareStatistice2018.pdf.

12. For more on the earlier Congress model of caste-based mobilisation in UP and its decline after the rise of caste-based parties, see Zoya Hasan, 'Transfer of power? Politics of mass mobilisation in UP', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 36, No. 46/47, 24–30 November 2001, pp. 4401–4409; Christophe Jaffrelot, *India's Silent Revolution: The Rise of Low Castes in North Indian Politics* (New Delhi: Permanent Black, 2003), pp. 48–143, 426–452; Christophe Jaffrelot, 'The rise of the Other Backward Classes in the Hindi belt', *The Journal of Asian Studies*, Vol. 59, No. 1, February 2000, pp. 86–108.

13. Interview with Brijesh Shukla, columnist, *Navbharat Times*, 11 June 2020, Lucknow. Also see his piece, 'BJP ke paas hai ati-pichhdon kee sanjeevani', *Navbharat Times*. The piece was written in May 2019, before the general election results were declared, after he had travelled 7,000 km to cover the poll campaign across UP.

14. Interview with one of the longest-serving MLAs in UP, who spoke off-the-record for this book, 9 June 2020.

15. This was the house of UP party leader and local magnate Sudhir Halwasiya. Rajiv Srivastava, 'Finally, a house for Amit Shah in Lucknow', *The Times of India*, 9 February 2014, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/Finally-a-house-for-Amit-Shah-in-Lucknow/articleshow/30075957.cms. For more on his 2013-14 UP campaign, see Lalmani Verma, 'The build-UP: Amit